

c. Click on the Activate link to turn the Plugin on.

5.1.2 Hiding plugins when deactivated

Some plugins feature tags inside of the template files. If the plugin is not activated, it will "break" the Theme and it may report errors or fail to load. It is therefore imperative to prevent the plugin from being detected in case it is turned off.

To detect if a plugin is installed, you can use a simple `function_exists()` check. The `if (function_exists())` checks for the plugin, and if it exists, it will use it. If it returns `FALSE` or "not found", it will ignore the plugin tag and continue loading the page.

```
<?php
if (function_exists('FUNCTION_NAME')) {
    FUNCTION_NAME();
}
?>
```

This example plugin uses a function called `jal_get_shoutbox()` to print out its contents.

```
<?php
if (function_exists('jal_get_shoutbox')) {
    jal_get_shoutbox();
}
?>
```

5.2 Troubleshooting plugins

If you are experiencing problems with a plugin you installed or one that stopped working after upgrading, the following are the steps you need to take to troubleshoot the plugin:

1. Check that any plugin tags or usage within your template files are correct, spelled right, and placed in the appropriate place, i.e., within the WordPress Loop or outside of it.
2. Check that you uploaded the file to the plugins folder under wp-content.
3. Check that the plugin has been activated in your Plugin Panel of your Administration Panels.
4. Deactivate and re-activate the plugin to see if this makes it work.

If the problem persists and you cannot seem to solve it, just check for similar plugins that do the same work. You will find plenty!